WINNER-TAKE-MOST

What 1,000 indie startups reveal about where capital actually concentrates

TRUSTMRR DATASET • 1,000 STARTUPS • AUG 2026

The market isn’t a bell curve

Revenue concentration across all 1,000 startups

49.6%

of all 30-day revenue
comes from just 10 startups

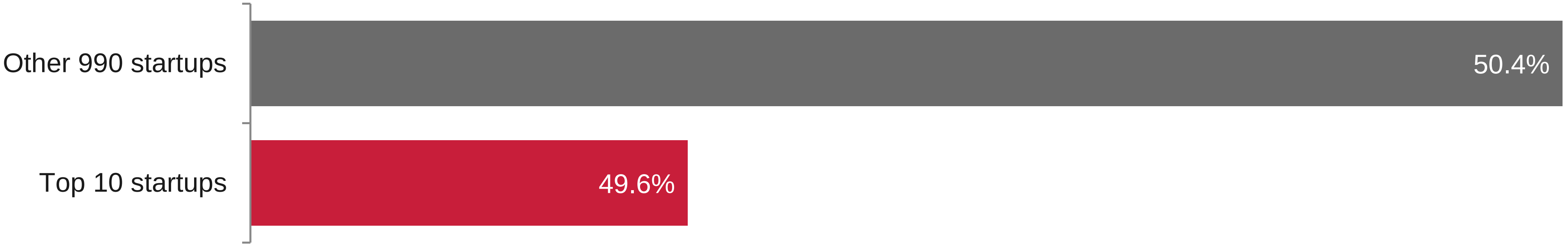
21.6%

of startups generate
$0 in revenue

1,000

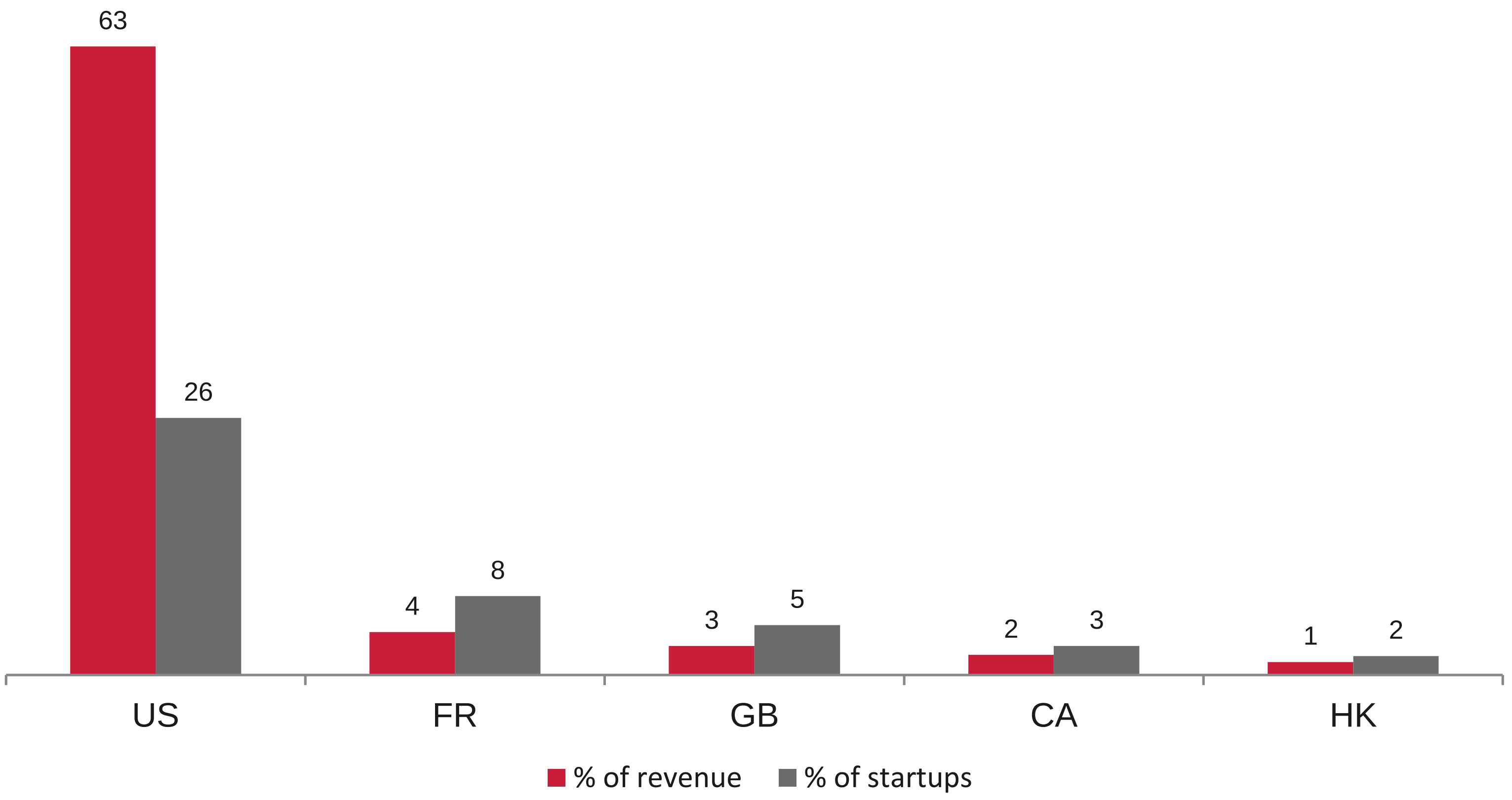
startups sampled
across 50+ countries

Share of total 30-day revenue



Capital doesn't spread — it pools

Revenue share vs. startup count share, by country



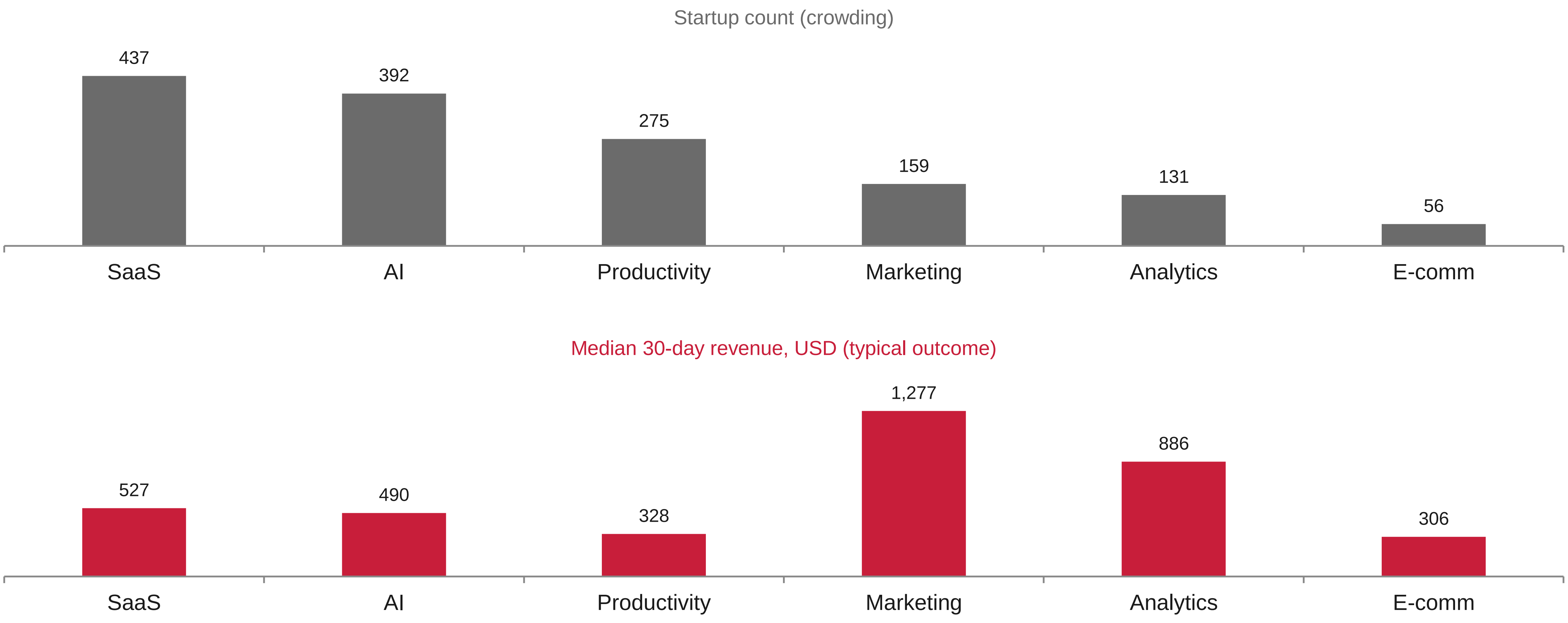
63%

of ALL revenue in the dataset comes from the US alone

— while holding only 26% of the startups. Every other country is a rounding error by comparison.

Crowded categories, weak medians

Number of startups vs. median 30-day revenue, by category



Exit prices don’t track performance

Among the 262 startups listed for sale

26.2%

of all startups in the dataset are listed for sale

0.09

correlation between asking price and 12-month revenue

2.3x

median revenue multiple asked — max seen: 327x

The read:

Sellers are pricing off a story, not a track record. A near-zero correlation between asking price and trailing revenue means the market for these businesses is inefficient — which is exactly where a disciplined buyer with real diligence finds mispriced deals.

What this means for capital

1

Concentration is the market

Half the revenue sits in 1% of startups. Underwrite for outliers, not averages.

2

Geography is a filter, not a strategy

The US isn't just bigger — it converts startup count into revenue 2.4x more efficiently than its population of founders would suggest.

3

Inefficiency is the opportunity

Near-zero correlation between price and performance in the on-sale cohort means diligence, not access, is the edge.